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SIA Event Codes – Complete DC-03 Code Reference

A comprehensive reference of all SIA DC-03 alarm event codes with descriptions, for use in alarm communication protocol implementations.

What is the SIA DC-03 protocol?

The SIA DC-03 protocol is a standard defined by the Security Industry Association (SIA) that establishes how alarm panels should send messages to a Central Monitoring Station (CMS).

It is characterized by:

- Readable ASCII text messages.
- Simple structure with abbreviated codes.
- Use of 2-letter prefixes (BA, YC, etc.) that identify the event type.
- Checksum verification.

Below are several examples of the SIA DC-03 protocol data format, extracted from the document.

Data Format Examples

1. Basic Data Packet Format

This is the simplest format, where only the data type and address are specified.

`Nri7/id1344/ss2DG115`: A new event (`N`) of access granted (`DG`) in area 7. The door ID is 115, and the user who accessed is number 1344 with sub-subscriber 2.

2. Format with Units

This example shows how units can be used to provide more specific data.

`EP*452C_`: An environmental event (`E`) of temperature in a cold room. The temperature is 45.2 degrees Celsius.

3. Communication Failure Example

This example illustrates how the protocol can handle a communication failure, specifying the cause of the error.

`Nrg02YC`: A new event (`N`) indicating that a communication failure (`YC`) has occurred in route group 2.

4. System Arming and Disarming Example

These examples are common for security events and show the use of the format for the system status.

`Nri3/id1234/ua1_`: The system in area 3 has been armed (`UA`) by user 1234.

`Nri3/id1234/ug1_`: The system in area 3 has been disarmed (`UG`) by user 1234.

5. Alarm Events Example

These examples describe specific alarm events, indicating the location of the event.

`Nri7/id234/fa107`: A new event (`N`) of fire alarm (`FA`) in area 7. The alarm point is zone 107.

`Nri7/id1234/ba105`: A new event (`N`) of burglary alarm (`BA`) in area 7. The alarm was caused by zone 105.

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Introduction to SIA Event Codes

The following table presents a comprehensive list of **Event Block Codes** as defined in the SIA DC03-1990 Digital Communications Standard.

These codes are used by alarm and security systems to communicate specific events and conditions from the transmitter (usually located at the protected premises) to the receiver (typically located at a central monitoring station).

Each event code is a two-letter identifier representing a particular status, alarm, or system condition.

These codes are essential for standardized and interoperable alarm communication, ensuring that equipment from different manufacturers can effectively interpret and respond to alarm signals.

Data Code	Short Description	Long Description	Address Field
AA	Alarm – Panel Substitution	An attempt to substitute an alternate alarm panel for a secure panel has been made	Condition number
AB	Abort	An event message was not sent due to User action	Zone or point
AN	Analog Restoral	An analog fire sensor has been restored to normal operation	Zone or point
AR	AC Restoral	AC power has been restored	Unused
AS	Analog Service	An analog fire sensor needs to be cleaned or calibrated	Zone or point
AT	AC Trouble	AC power has been failed	Unused
BA	Burglary Alarm	Burglary zone has been violated while armed	Zone or point
BB	Burglary Bypass	Burglary zone has been bypassed	Zone or point
BC	Burglary Cancel	Alarm has been cancelled by authorized user	User number